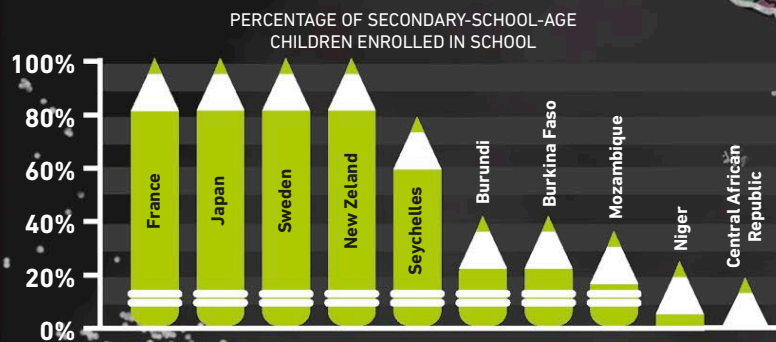


Canada
About 16 percent of Canadians struggle to pass basic literary tests.

Going to secondary school

Wealthy nations can afford to provide secondary education for all children, but governments in poorer countries cannot offer every child a place. This is particularly true in Africa south of the Sahara. In Niger, for example, only 24 percent of children go to secondary school.



Literacy

Literacy—being able to read and write—is an essential life skill. Being literate makes it easier for people to learn, make the most of their abilities, and get better jobs. High levels of illiteracy make it difficult for nations to develop and become wealthier.

Europe
Although most countries in Europe have very high literacy rates, more than 55 million adults classed as “literate” still lack basic reading and writing skills.

United States
About 21 percent of adults in the US are classed as “functionally illiterate.”

Mauritania
Little more than half of Mauritania’s population—52.1 percent—can read and write.

Chad
Just 23.3 percent of people in Chad are literate—the world’s lowest literacy rate.

Brazil
Just over nine out of every ten Brazilians are literate.

IN DEVELOPING COUNTRIES,
200 MILLION PEOPLE AGES
15–24 HAVE NOT COMPLETED
PRIMARY SCHOOL